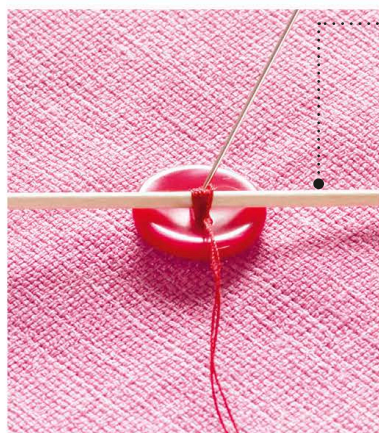


FASTENINGS

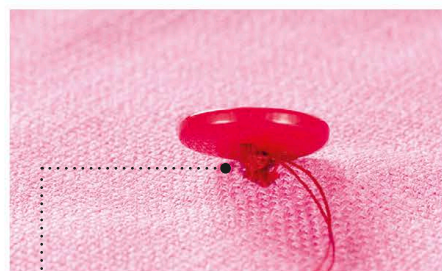
Although fastenings have a practical use – securing closings on cushion covers, bags, garments, and home accessories – many of them also serve as decorative

finishing details. Techniques for adding very simple fastenings are provided here, including hand-stitched buttonholes, press studs, and zips.

SEWING ON BUTTONS

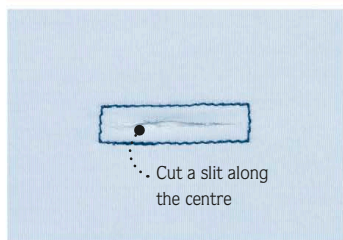


1 Thread your needle with a double strand of thread. Secure the thread to the fabric where the button is to be positioned. Pass the needle up through one hole of the button, down through the other hole to the back. Do not pull the thread taut yet – first insert a cocktail stick (or match stick) under the stitch. Then pull the thread taut. Continue working back and forth through the holes of the button and the fabric, until at least five stitches have been worked.

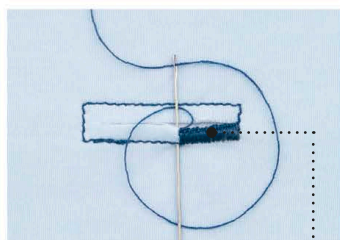


2 Remove the cocktail stick. Wrap the working thread several times around the thread under the button to form a shank. Secure the thread end with three small stitches at the back.

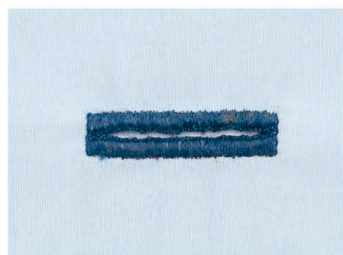
HAND-STITCHED BUTTONHOLES



1 Mark the desired finished length of the buttonhole on the right side of the piece, then machine stitch a rectangle 6mm (1/4in) wide and as long as the required finished buttonhole length. Carefully cut a slit along the exact centre of this rectangle.



2 Using a thick, strong buttonhole thread, work tailor's buttonhole stitch (as shown) along both edges of the slit. Insert the needle through the fabric just outside the machine stitches, so that the stitches are 3mm (1/8in) long.



3 Finish each end of the buttonhole with three or four stitches that are the same width as the total width of the buttonhole. Always work buttonholes through two layers of fabric that have an interfacing in between them.

SEWING ON PRESS STUDS

Secure the press studs with several stitches



Although press studs, or poppers, are not visible, align them carefully when sewing them on. Use a doubled thread and work three or more stitches through each hole around the edge of the press stud pieces.